

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 6

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ETHNOGRAPHIC DICTIONARY • Order of Letters Adopted for the Dictionary

The translation of the botanical terms are by M. Theodore Monod who has kindly given to me his “Teda botanical vocabulary” and who, besides, identified the plants of a herbarium gathered, at my request, by the children of the Kanuri school in Bilma.

[127](#)
[Historical And Archival Research](#)

[128](#)
[Organization And Analysis Of Results](#)

But his help goes beyond the bounds of a simple scientific contribution: the material means put at my disposal by the I.F.A.N. have made it possible for me to publish these manuscripts; the confidence that Monsieru Monod has shown me has supported me in my wish to accomplish this task.

[122](#)
[Practical Preparations Of Fieldwork](#)

M. Charles Le Coeur.

[pp. 10–52 not translated]

[122](#)
[Practical Preparations Of Fieldwork](#)

ETHNOGRAPHIC DICTIONARY

A

abba (pl. abbaa): father — synonym: zume; zebe or abba bwi: grandfather (see: dezze): title of respect which one readily gives an old man. — dezzebe: great-grandfather.

Abali: Teda form of the name of an associate of the Prophet. Teski Sidinabali (or Elitabali): constellation of Orion.

[122](#)
[Practical Preparations Of Fieldwork](#)

[135](#)
[Mineral Resources](#)

[136](#)
[Fauna](#)

abekonar: flower of a shrub common in Tibesti. Several species are confused under this name.

137
Flora

aberi: flat stone on which an animal is skinned.

151
Sensation And
Perception

abeso: open-work basket made of plaited leaf strips of doom palm, in which are macerated nuts of the doom palm to extract the juice. See kele (M.H., Col. Le C., no. 32-50-146).

171
Comparative Evidence

abi: (pl. abea): distraction, play. In this general sense it is used with the verb terar, to go out; in the more restricted sense of women's dance it is used with the verb nar, to pose. The dance involves several steps, or rather several moments and several figures that permit the introduction of variations (photos Plate XXVII).^A

177
Acculturation And
Culture Contact

There are two principal movements:

182
Functional/Adaptational
Interpretations

1. abi ofulo, or: ofore: ofore cebapwe: "they pose the ofore"—the dancer gives herself impetus by throwing her arms from back to front and clapping her hands at the end of the forward movement, once or twice according to whether the rhythm is slow or fast. The swinging of the trunk and the flexing of the knees extend the rhythm to the entire body;

184
Cultural Participation

2. abi arasa: when there is still swinging of the arms but without clapping of the hands, and when the feet take 755 cont.part in the dance either by stamping in place or by shifting sideways or back to front with small rhythmic steps: right foot—left foot, left foot—right foot, each foot rejoining the preceding one, then the other way around.

192
Vocabulary

The principal figures are:

201
Gestures And Signs

a) the line from which a dancer sometimes detaches herself and improvises a personal step while her companions give the rhythm by clapping an accelerated ofulo;

211
Mnemonic Devices

b) the circle who dance the ofulo or the arasa;

220
Food Quest

c) a sort of round-about in which two or three rows of a half-dozen women holding themselves by their little fingers advance, one behind the other, while turning around a center;

221
Annual Cycle

d) the vis-a-vis, in which two rows of women face each other while dancing a combination 56 of the ofulo and the arasa: two steps forward and a clapping of hands, two steps backward and another clap. Leaps in place of several persons may cut these figures when the abi takes place at a wedding.

222
Collecting

The dance is always accompanied by singing. Sometimes the women are content to sing together a classical refrain, the most common of which: ginne gon: "come down, take," seems to be an invitation to abduction; sometimes one of them improvises a song in praise of her father, of a chief or of the man in honor of whom the festival takes place; husband, father of the wife, etc... In these latter cases, the man thus celebrated must give the singer a gift; the other women mark the singing with their refrain. When the festival is important, it is enhanced with one or several drums:

231
Domesticated Animals

233
Pastoral Activities

237
Animal By-Products

241
Tillage

243
Cereal Agriculture

251
Preservation And
Storage Of Food

252
Food Preparation

262
Diet

263
Condiments

1. The tarare which the blacksmith hangs around his neck, and the two sides of which he beats in time, with his hands, while singing like the women;

2. the nayara, which is hung from a tree or a post and on which one or two free men beat double blows with sticks, without paying attention to the time, with accompaniment of leaps and gestures, arms outspread, which make the sleeves of the "boubou" flutter, so that it is more like a special dance than a musical accompaniment, although the tumult and the general excitement are very much increased. Other men take pleasure in passing in front of the

dancers and raising their you-you while brandishing a knife or a javelin above their heads or firing a gun.

If there are many men, they arrange themselves in single file and dance their step, called siginnj, which is similar to the arasa but with swinging trunk and arms and without the accompaniment of singing. The abbi presents a spectacle which does not lack bonhomie; to one side of the dancing group the men are sitting and chatting by the light of the moon; others are sleeping, stretched out on the sand, children are playing, a grandmother is looking for her daughter so that she may suckle her baby. However, the whole has the character of ■ 856 cont.very pronounced sexual excitement that emphasizes a certain number of prohibitions: the old people do not avoid the spectacle of the abi when it takes place, for example, in the afternoon or at a spot where they are already gathered together; but it would be improper for them to come specially to see it. The young women themselves cease taking part when they have a daughter and, above all, a son past infancy, because they would be ashamed to have the latter see them, and a young girl or a married woman who behaves properly would never risk one of those personal singing or dancing numbers by which the ogu attract suitors.

aabo (pl. aaba): terminal bud of the trunk that promotes the growth of the date palm. The Teda like to eat it raw or cooked. But removing it causes the tree to die.

abor (pl. abora): (*Citrullus colocynthis*)—1. wild bitter cucumber that camels do not eat, but that women gather. They soak the seeds in water mixed with ashes, dry them in the sun, then beat them on a millstone or on a flat rock with a stone that they take care to wield from right to left and from left to right so as to remove only the husk. The white seeds that now appear are then put back into the water mixed with ashes that 57 is warmed for three hours. They are then washed in cold water, dried in the sun, and finally pounded in a wooden mortar. The oily flour thus obtained is mixed with the flour of dried dates to form a dish called taa or tinne aborde or abbreviated: abor (see taa): 2. synonym of kome, calabash (see this word) (M.H., Co. Le C., 35-50-91).

abuterki: abcess, boil that is treated with a plaster of bean flour or of bird droppings.

aca: baggage

acaba: twins; aca lao: one of two.

ace: old woman

acuno: a kind of purgative herb.

adab: gold, gold ornament. Each of these is known to the Teda only by hearsay.

adabo or adao or adaba: grass of the genus "Aristida" eaten by all the animals of the Djado.

adaha: almost (expressing time), for example: almost nine o'clock.

adaguli: small white sand lizard.

adebi (pl. adeba): woman. The condition of the Teda woman, though not as elevated as that of the Tuareg woman, springs from the same type of chivalrous morals. The woman's life passes through four phases: 1. childhood: the birth of a girl is in principle less desirable than that of a boy. Nonetheless, public opinion acknowledges that girls will remain closer to their parents and are less exposed than their brothers to violent deaths; it ■ 957 cont.is best to have an equal number of children of both sexes, and the little girls are, in fact, almost always more spoiled than the little boys. Until almost the age of two years they go naked, their shaved heads adorned simply with a

264
Eating

281
Work In Skins

283
Cordage

285
Mats And Basketry

291
Normal Garb

294
Clothing Manufacture

301
Ornament

302
Personal Grooming

304
Body Alterations

317
Special Deposits

322
Woodworking

326
Smiths And Their Crafts

342
Dwellings

386
Paint And Dye Manufacture

411
Weapons

412
General Tools

416
Appliances

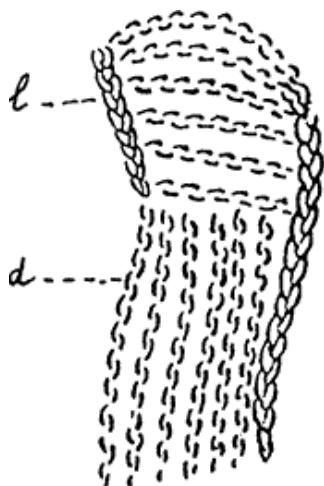
417
Apparatus

422
Property In Movables

426
Borrowing And Lending

431
Gift Giving

few tufts of hair, and differ from boys only in that they wear bracelets of copper (mirki) on the ankles and small ear loops of silver or thread.



Then, and until the age of about seven, they wear a small loin-cloth (tallao) made of strips of leather ornamented with cowries, according to the ancient fashion which continues to prevail on the mountain, or made of a bit of rectangular material, according to the recent fashion which is widespread among the Teda of the plain who are in contact with Arabs and Kanuri. Their hair is arranged in front with a dozen small longitudinal plaits which go from the top of the head to the edge of the forehead where they join a transverse plait (liha) which borders them; in the back and on the sides, other small plaits hang freely (daha). One lets them have small collars and small bracelets of beads. Around the age of seven, the little girls replace the loincloth with a cloth skirt, preferably white, then with a "boubou" (kobo) of blue cloth. Their right nostril is pierced with a hole in which is introduced a small bit of wood that is chosen with a diameter that becomes progressively larger as the little girl grows, until 58 the hole can take the silver ring of more than a centimeter in diameter, which is one of the principal ornaments of the woman.

Beginning at this age, sometimes even sooner, little girls help their mothers pound grain, date kernels, doom nuts, throw wood on the fire, carry the babies; they tend the goats and sheep when they do not have a brother of an age to do it. Above all, they play in the camp with the other children, run about, or draw in the sand the plan of their wedding hut. During festivals they form a small group that practices dancing like the women, but that the group of little boys generally puts an end to by charging and breaking up, amidst cries and laughter.

2. Adolescence: after 12 years the young girl, fero, gives up her hair style of transverse plaits above her forehead and replaces the dozen small longitudinal plaits with three plaits, also longitudinal, (dobbo) and a little thicker. She wears trinkets and the costume of the women: the peplum (ebi) that finishes off a small piece of material (ebi, lao, mindil) which ■ 1058 cont. covers the hair and with which she veils her mouth as she turns her head as soon as a stranger looks at her. She becomes actually very shy, scarcely going alone from the house, lowers her eyes when she finds herself in public. She continues, nevertheless, to take part in the general life, and it may happen that she will give a young man to understand that she loves him and would like him to propose marriage. But it is very rare that she will tell him so expressly, and almost impossible that she will speak of it to her parents. In fact, it would be extremely shameful on her part to allude to her future marriage or, above all, to indicate a preference for one suitor rather than another.

She must accept without a word the one whom her parents choose, leave, if he displeases her, by

435
Price And Value

438
Internal Trade

439
External Trade

465
Wages And Salaries

484
Travel

492
Animal Transport

531
Decorative Art

532
Representative Art

533
Music

534
Musical Instruments

535
Dance

539
Literary Texts

548
Illegal Entertainment

551
Personal Names

554
Status, Role, And
Prestige

556
Accumulation Of
Wealth

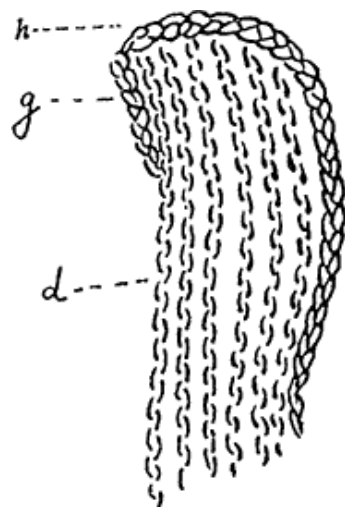
561
Age Stratification

562
Gender Status

571
Social Relationships
And Groups

574
Visiting And
Hospitality

576
Etiquette



resolving to escape from his house on the days following the consumation of her marriage. Being betrothed, she must have sense of shame and hide her face in front of her fiancé and her future parents-in-law, while showing them great respect, in particular her mother-in-law whom she must be the first to greet, timidly, in a low voice and with her face veiled when she meets her.

3. Youth: the young woman plaits her hair as before in two braids (hiše) instead of three. She observes the same principles of modesty as the girl and especially when she is betrothed. She never eats in front of her husband. As long as she does not have children and cannot call him "father of so-and-so" [male] or "father of so-and-so" [female], she is embarrassed to address him. When she dances, she generally keeps her eyes lowered, the same attitude mixed with coquetry and fear as when a stranger meets her at the well. This fear is justified: raping a woman whose family one does not know or who has no family to protect her is, in fact, quite admissible and even praised in the morals of the male Teda; on the other hand, the type of feminine beauty of which men dream is represented by long, lowered eyelashes on a long, oval very regular face framed by long pendant braids.⁵⁹ This show of reserve is a sort of sheltering wall from which the young woman has only more boldness and caprice. She no longer keeps herself in the background like the young girl. She likes to make the prestige of her 15 or 16 years felt. For a yes or no, for a dish not sufficiently appreciated, for a gift refused or simply postponed, she escapes to the house of her parents from which her husband can make her return only by sending a gift of reconciliation (doore), a goat or a date palm, for example. Whereas, on the other hand, the husband, accustomed ■ 1159 cont. to the food of his mother, easily grows impatient with the culinary inexperience and the conjugal despotism of his young wife; divorces are frequent, even when there are one or two children. The young woman then becomes an ogu along with the other young divorced women and the young widows whose period of mourning is over. Their happy band is the center of the social life of the Teda. They organize dances and often choose a leader from among them, a bu adeba, in whose hut they spend the night with young men, a sort of course of love resembling that of the Tuareg, but more rustic. Flirtation is not only permitted but recommended. Nevertheless, it would be shameful for an ogu to give herself to a man, more shameful still secretly to prepare food for him, even more so to have an illegitimate child by him which, formerly, had to be put to death; and in spite of their freedom of conduct, in general, interest and self esteem keep the ogu from granting the advantages of marriage to a man who refuses to pay for it. One brands with the name "sugonne": "fast woman" the women who make an exception to this rule, sometimes on the strength of a false promise of marriage. They are, on the whole, very rare except near infantry posts where the bait of money and to some extent being afraid of the more capable [?] make many women slip into prostitution which was unknown among the Teda before the French occupation.

577

Ethics

578

Ingroup Antagonisms

583

Mode Of Marriage

584

Arranging A Marriage

585

Nuptials

586

Termination Of
Marriage

587

Secondary Marriages

589

Celibacy

591

Residence

593

Family Relationships

595

Polygamy

601

Kinship Terminology

604

Avuncular And
Nepotic Relatives

606

Parents-In-Law And
Children-In-Law

609

Behavior Toward Non-
Relatives

614

Clans

648

External Relations

671

Legal Norms

683

Offenses Against The
Person

721

Instigation Of War

752

4. Maturity: As women age, the manifestations of modesty, while still being complied with, become more mechanical. It is very rare that a woman, even in advanced age, does not have a husband; she is nonetheless very independent. While her husband tends the camels in his pasture at the foot of the mountain, or takes part in a raid or, today, is in prison for some defiance of French authority, the wife often remains for long months alone with her children, in a palm grove where she waters her garden, or in another pasture that is more suitable for goats. Often too she undertakes long journeys. When she is no longer very young she will willingly tolerate that her husband have a second wife in another village; some clever compliments, a little gift will, if necessary, help the thing to pass, if she still has some coquetry. But unless she herself is of servile origin or very fat or poor, she will never consent that the new spouse will be installed alongside her. Though submitting, in principle, to her husband, she always and often very violently has her say in all household matters, and returns blow for blow if her husband beats her. She is armed with a small knife which she carries in her belt; she likes to hold in her hand, when she is out walking, a cudgel is a long, pointed antelope horn. There are also special women's swords. The weapons serve them less to defend themselves against the men than to settle their numerous quarrels with other women. They take part with 60 passion in the life of the community; 1260 cont. when a group of men is discussing a question in which a woman is interested, she will sit down a little to one side and, when the moment comes, take the word, turning slightly in profile, but [speaking] clearly and spiritedly. When a chief wishes to make a proclamation he calls together the women as well as the men, and it is rare that some among them do not break in on the debate. They are only silenced if their quarrelsome mood carries them too far and endangers the public peace which is the chief object of these assemblies and of all male politics. On the whole, by force or by ruse, the man almost always ends by imposing his authority as head, which no woman contests in principle; but in everything he does and in everything he says, he is infinitely more anxious for the opinion of the woman than the woman is of the man's opinion, and when a man meets a woman, custom requires that he greet first, just as the young person first greets the old, and the subordinate his superior.

adedi: glasses, mirror, photographic apparatus. The only mirror the Teda know are small, rectangular pocket mirrors that Arabs sell for women.

ader (pl. adera): herd, flock.

adersan: plant found in the Djado, good for camels (Haplophyllum tuberculatum).

adersan: commercial perfume that merchants sell to women (see: soro).

adezoõ or: adezoma: north star (see: teski).

adi: scorpion (see: eti).

addi: here, the opposite of: tedi, and: tea, there (see ayi, aya, here, still closer).

addi addi: little by little, very little.

adofa, or: subo (see the general term: terke): woman's camel saddle, a pyramidal frame of solidly fastened sticks and hoops, covered, in the Daza land, by stitched cowhide or antelope hide, in Tibesti by cotton fabrics. Leather cushions (oderi), rectangular pieces of skin ornamented with cowries (dela), red and green striped cloths or covers, of Fezzan origin (borro) are laid inside.—Hanging on the outside, large pieces of black wood (sahari); basket-work trays (olisi), enamel cups (tasu) complete the decoration. Straps ornamented with cowries fasten the saddle to the camel. Generally bought in Kanem, more frequently among the Teda of Tibesti, prevalent among the Daza where it is richly ornamented, it is little used among the Teda of the west where the women use the ordinary pack saddle or terke, like the men.

Bodily Injuries

757

Medical Therapy

778

Sacred Objects And Places

779

Theological Systems

782

Prayers And Sacrifices

783

Purification And Atonement

787

Revelation And Divination

788

Ritual

797

Missions

805

Ordering Of Time

821

Ethnometeorology

822

Ethnophysics

824

Ethnobotany

831

Sexuality

832

Sexual Stimulation

834

General Sex Restrictions

836

Premarital Sex Relations

839

Miscellaneous Sex Behavior

848

Illegitimacy

851

Social Placement

852

However, sometimes the women use a sort of pack saddle (gomme) where the front and back forks of the terke are surmounted by an arch which reaches to the height of the waist, a sort of guard rail for two or three children ■ 1360 cont. which the woman places around her. The same kind of saddle as this, but smaller, serves to load baggage from the house (mats, etc...); it is called: buroro.

adraso: surname which is either a nickname given a person by his mother (see: josor and: cer) or by his friends, or a secondary name of the clan handed down in the uterine line. The surname of an individual has a meaning: it is not, however, a word current in the language: it exists only as a surname, but traditionally it is given a meaning. (See list of first names and surnames, p. 182).

61

ae (pl. aa): camel (general term). The possession of this animal without which they would be cut off from the rest of the world, is the object of the greatest pride conceivable to the Teda; no effort or sacrifice is too great when it comes to the well-being of their camels. Although the Teda camels are almost all accustomed to the mountain roads that make the feet of camels from outside the region bleed, they never pass the entire year in Tibesti. The best pastures are on the periphery of the mountain, which is the chief place of residence of the richest Teda families and particularly of the three chief clans (Tomagra—Gunda—Arinda). (See dooge.) The camels at rest pasture unshackled, sometimes several days' journey from their owner. The scarcity of watering places keeps them within a definite radius, and their inability to water themselves often makes them gather around a well where they wait patiently until the first comer—according to the law of the nomads—waters them, even if he does not know their owner.

However, it very often happens, when rains have replenished the pools toward the south, especially when males and females are together, that they go there, a hundred or two hundred kilometers distant; their owner relies on finding them by their footprints in the sand. There is, in fact, not a Teda who does not know the individual imprints of each of his camels, and often those of others. Marks (arbi) imprinted with a red-hot iron on the body of the animal, which reflect all the confused alliances of families and clans, have limited, to a certain degree, camel thefts which, regarded as a feat of glorious war, were, as a result, not infrequent, and formed the center of Teda political life before the French occupation.

The Teda train young camels by mounting them bareback and making them gallop until they are tired or until they throw off their rider who, in this case, remounts immediately. They train them to obey their voice, they restrain them by clicking their tongue against the palate (which the French use in the opposite way, to urge them on) and make them go by a clicking against the teeth and by interjections such as: hop, hok, hot or: aya, the latter serving ■ 1461 cont. also to stop the camel. The names of camels differ with the age of the animal: erej: colt up to four or five years.

ākarde, or āgarde: adult camel, ākarde adigre: up to seven or eight years—ākarde holi□ede: over eight years.

Qualifications applied to camels: ougi: that escapes when one approaches; vertegide: nervous, that gets up quickly when one mounts it; saggar: reddish brown with white feet; mini: yellow; kelekele: red mixed with white; toyu: snow white (the camels of Air); olle koroco: light brown with white feet.

(Some of these words are common names of colors: mini, for example—the others do not seem to be used in the current language as the names of colors.)

afor: Rumex vesicarius, some of which make an infusion to season the millet porridge.

Ceremonial During
Infancy And Childhood

857
Childhood Activities

858
Status Of Children

881
Puberty And Initiation

882
Status Of Adolescents

885
Adulthood

887
Activities Of The Aged

888
Status And Treatment
Of The Aged

agadi: leather thong.

62

agala: cord that one fastens to the lower jaw of a camel to attach it to a row of camels.

āgal or ākal: thought, intention. agalhena marce: his thought is finished, that is to say, he no longer understands anything. – āgala wodo: bad thought, dishonest. – āgalde: intelligent, thoughtful.

āgal kosar, āgal yugos: recover consciousness (after fainting, for example).

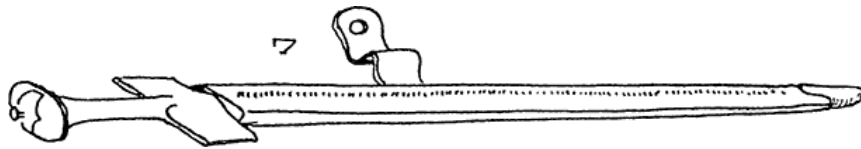
āgalner, āgalce, āgalnter: pay attention, to reflect.

agar: plaited leather thongs forming small decorative cords.

āgarde: camel from four to six years. It represents an important gift (dorre) or reconciliation equivalent to 12 good goats or 20 poor ones.

āgarde edigre: camel of six to eight years.

agaso (pl. agasa): Tuareg sabre with a hilt in the shape of a cross. (M.H., Col. Le C., 35-50-7).



agelano or agelasab: plant (Kawar) (Pentizia monodiana).

agaske: wrist, see: kobe gwi, literally: "the neck of the hand."

agerbi: son-in-law.

agoges: species of date common in the Kawar where it is called karab. Little valued in the Djado where it is used before it ripens, as part of camel fodder.

agor: large pen for goats, sheep or donkeys (see: kor).

agorder, agorci, agornder: to measure a length.

agoršiu: plant of the pastures of Agadem (Ephrada tilhoana).

agudi or agude: day after tomorrow.

1562 cont.

āker: male.

ākernar, ākerce, ākertar: to deny.

ala: shell.

alamo: flag. The use of a small flag to mark a holy place is, like the word itself, of Arabian origin. Until now it has been used in Tibesti only by the missionaries of the Snoussia; it is more common in the Kawar.

ale (pl. alea): ring that the Teda blacksmiths make, usually by melting pieces of silver.



(M.H., col. Le. C. 35–50, 220). It is inconvenient for a man to wear rings except on the little finger and on the third finger, and it is necessary to take them off to pray if they are not pure silver. However, this last prescription is little observed.

ale sulu: ring without a pearl—ale eride: ring with pearl—ale tobolde: ring similar to a signet ring (tobol: turban)—ale tabaki: simple ring of silver.

allifo, or: ali, or: ale: fontanel (?)—brain: the blacksmiths use the 63 carbonized brain of an animal which they reduce to powder and mix with butter to stretch the skin of their drums.

alin: powder bought to dye cloth black or blue. Comes from Bornu or Mirria (region of Ziner) where it is obtained by crushing the leaves of a plant.

alkaõ or alkam (pl. alkama): (see: bare) wheat that the Teda grow in the irrigated gardens of Tibesti. It is the cereal that is most appreciated. It is planted in the mountain at the beginning of November and harvested in May or June. But from the month of April, the grains, still green, are eaten by children or roasted by the women in a hole in the sand where a fire has just been burning. Dishes of wheat meal: fotass, fonasso or dogo, toska,—the word alkam also means a skin color (see asi).

amma: but: Adebi tiri, amma gale geno: “a pretty but bad woman.”

amanor: (I): to have confidence (?)

aami: Black seeds that bear the yi, siwak in Arabic (*Salvadora persica*), at the beginning of summer. They are very appreciated by the Teda who crunch them or make of them a kind of sweet flour which they prefer to that obtained from the pulp of the doom nut.

anna (plural of: aõ).

anege: left as opposed to: bori: right. Anegede: left-handed (person). Kobe anegede yeso: “go to the left,” one can also say: kobe anege lao.

aner: milk of an animal about to drop its young; aner cooked: kukur.

📄 1663 cont.

a□a (pl. a□aa): branch of date palm that bears the cluster.

a□eli: shelter made of four trunks, generally of a doom palm, which support a roof of date twigs on which dates are dried; people take a siesta in its shade. Sometimes they lie on the roof to be sheltered from mosquitoes. But these shelters are scarcely found except in Tibesti, in Kavar the construction material is lacking.

aõ (pl. anna): (sometimes: amo, pl. anna) individual—people—anna followed by the possessive: the family, example: anna nera, my own people—anna ba: the parents, old kinship—anna geena, the people of the walls, or: anna bona, the people of the mattock, that is to say, the sedentary people—anna yogana: the people from outside: the nomads.

āpaner, āpayi, āpanter: to keep house for someone. apade: a person who keeps house for another, manager, sometimes host.

arobo: blind.

araken: capable.

araku: previously. Used alone, can mean last month or more particularly: the day before yesterday. But in this case, one generally specifies: araku duski “day-before-yesterday morning,”—araku tume, or araku dogoso “day-before-yesterday evening.”

aranar, arayi, arantar: to lead animals on a leash.

ara□ar, araci, arākar: to support.

arbasa: onions which the Teda cultivate sometimes, to season their gruel, which they more often buy from the Tuareg caravaneers.

arbi: (see: yele) a sort of coat-of-arms—mark of the owner branded with a red-hot iron on a camel or, as a substitute, a donkey. The number of signs in use is about 20. Each clan in the male line is characterized at the same time by a 64 combination of three signs and by the parts of the animal on which they are applied. It is not the purpose of the mark to permit the owner to distinguish his animals from those of others, for he knows them without that, but to prevent thieves from stealing the animals of a related or allied clan or of a clan from which he fears vengeance. Furthermore, one often adds to one's own mark the most important sign of the maternal uncle's mark, especially in case of a powerful clan. Naturally, the animals given on the occasion of a marriage keep their original mark so that the multiple marks of a camel reflect the total alliances of its owner.

A Teda is very flattered when a stranger borrows his mark, that is to say, his protection. (Dazza and Azza). The subordinate clans have a mark that differs but little from the mark of the seignorial clan to which they are connected. Donkeys are generally marked with only two signs. These are sometimes special signs. More often  1764 cont. they are signs of the maternal clan, for the donkey, the animal of women, who rarely marry outside their home, remains always in the narrow circle where the clan is numerous, known and respected. Out of pride, one also engraves one's mark with a red-hot iron on the handle of a whip, a large stick. It is rarely put on a stone. However, a block of tuff near the sulphur springs of Soboro (Tibesti) is covered with them.

One can recognize two or three types of arbi in this jumble of shapes:

1. Combinations of purely geometric lines which perhaps result in a too elaborate stylization of elements of representation: □ called, picturesquely, doroye dorano: "you have seen," "you have not seen"; □: erridigi; □: nehi (etc...);
2. Stylized representations of common objects: □ muzri: one of the most frequent marks because it is that of the seignorial clan of the Tomagra: it is the representation of the javelin, the weapon of the ancestors. □: the tomre, hatchet of iron which is used to cut tree branches, to prune the palms. The yogoi (see this word): hook of iron hafted, used to shake branches and knock down the carobs, or break tips□;
3. Representation of parts of animals, sometimes still linked with a remnant of totemism (see yugote): armatrokwon: hoof of the donkey. □—ouisse: foot of the crow: □ or: □; wudentigi: foot of the doe □. Sometimes the representation is the same, but the name given varies according to the clan.

As a whole, one may class the clans in groups by the coats-of-arms of which are characterized by the use of the same principal sign: Derdekichia and Emmeouya have in common the foot of the donkey. The javelin, chief sign of the dominant clan of the Tomagra, also characterizes the old clans of the interior: the Godoba, the Keessa, the Kocheda, the Tozoba. Derdékichia and Emméouya also possess it as a secondary sign. Clans of purely geographic origin, such as the Tamertioua, also have the donkey foot because the Derdékichia and the Emméouya dominate among them. On the other hand, the Tarsoa have the javelin because most of them come from the Tomagra. As a result of this complexity, the coat-of-arms, combined with historical tradition and habitation, constitutes a characteristic distinction of the clan, but that alone is insufficient to describe it.

65

arbuner, arbuyi, arbuntar: to design, to write: yeno arbedade: thing written; areba: writing—designs—marks (pl. of arbi).

ardiana: paradise.

1865 cont.

ardiner, or: hardiner, ardeye, ardenter: to thank (see lertii)—to have confidence—to accept in acknowledgment; ardino kogaya mari: “allow me to take the hen.”

arre: wax to stretch the skin of the drum.

are: house of mats built to shelter the young man circumcised, during his recovery; the expression: are de yidisi means “he sleeps in the house of the young circumcised one” (see kafo), is synonymous with: “he is circumcised.”

arei: strong wind accompanied by a thick cloud of sand which usually precedes heavy rains.

arenar, areye, arentar: to mock.

arfo: the palm branch attached to the trunk of the palm tree. After being cut it takes the shape of a shell. In times of scarcity, to bridge the gap at the end of winter, they crush the fiber of these shells, then cook it, then dry it, then cook it again to make a flour called dii arfo which they eat as a porridge called: tibi arfo.

arkage or orkoge: moist earth that is more or less salt or native natron characteristic of salt marshes and of most of the palm groves.

arke: plant frequent in the Djado (Boerhavia repens), the seeds are edible.

arkeno: a bush without thorns (Maerua crassifolia).

arki: a kind of wild cereal, the seeds of which the women gather after the rains.

armaso: donkey droppings (see orme, pl. arma: donkey).

arne or orne (pl. arna): stranger, guest. There are two kinds ordinary travelers unknown to all, to whom the village must give food for three days only, and guests properly speaking whom a tacit agreement, generally hereditary, links to the person who undertakes to care for them. These relations of hospitality, in the Kavar, form the social frame of dealings between the Teda and the Kanuri, on the one hand, the Kanuri and the Tuareg, on the other. Formerly, the Kanuri guest, moreover, served as go-between to buy back captives taken by the Tuareg and Teda. (See article: kasoga and “Teda texts”.)

aro (pl. ara): see: terke—lower cross-piece of the saddle.

arro (pl. arra): (diminutive: arei)—he-goat. arro jermuswa: he-goat whose horns, grasped by the hands, extend a little beyond the first, that is to say, still young but already nice and plump; such an animal must be given as indemnity to a man one has wounded, for, by eating it, he will quickly recover. arebbe: scapegoat ceremony in Tibesti.

arsanane: bud of date.

arsebabo: date still green that nevertheless can be eaten.

arši: (cocculus pendulus). Vine that winds itself around trees and that camels like very much. Humans eat its red berries in the rainy season.

1965 cont.

artas (pl. artasa): rifle bullet.

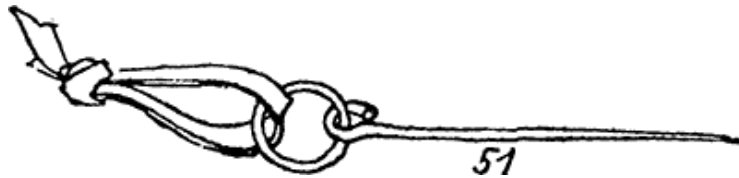
ašaa: synonym of sēlgi or, in Daza: lifini (see under sēlgi and under gobernar: to tan) (Pergularia tomentosa).

asar: ruin, by extension, loss or, more generally, conviction. Asar tiyubu: "ruin or loss, or condemnation has struck me," literally: "has eaten me"—they also say assartidinne.

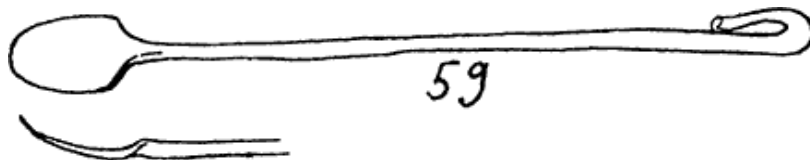
ašebi or ašibi: planed wood, ready to be used—haft of the lance or the javelin: child's javelin made simply of a stick of wood with a pointed end (M.H., Col. Le C.; 32-50-195).

asebo or asabo: iron—also means: arms (pl. asoba).

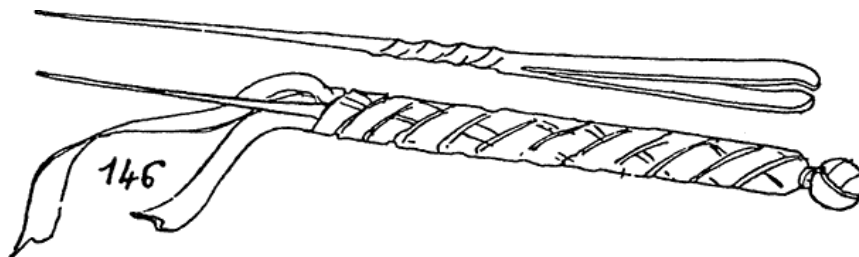
aseno or asono (pl. asona): puncheon (51)—asono tinne "a puncheon of various uses: [?] is a puncheon of iron



about ten centimeters long attached to a small piece of round wood and used by women for basket-making. asono bubur or: asono bela: "puncheon knife," sometimes also hafted, but its iron end at 12 centimeters, is enlarged



to form a blade with cutting edges; it is used to extract teeth by loosening them and to cut the uvula of children (M.H. Col. Le C., 32–50, 59)—ason otumugwi or togwi (M.H. Col. Le C., 32–50, 146): "tweezer puncheon,"



of 16 centimeters, without a wooden handle, one end of which forms tweezers, the other a puncheon. The puncheon serves to dislodge splinters which are then removed with the tweezers (figure 146 shows the "asono tumugwi," uncovered, and in its leather case; it is the indispensable 2066 cont. instrument in the bundle taken on a Teda journey, in which it is put along with the Teda tinder box (see: wunei), some pieces of natural natron—ends of string—old European buttons, etc...asono duune is a big awl used to sew the skins of the feet of camels and also to bleed the animals. asono wunij: "puncheon of fire," this is a shaft of iron about 20 centimeters⁶⁷ long which is driven into a cylindrical handle of wood and is used to make sparks and to brand the animals (M.H., Col. Le C., 32-50-52).

aši or: aše: 1. skin of men and of animals;

2. leather (for tanning, see governor) aši gobortada: tanned akin—aši yedaano: skin of "filali"; /?/

3. wealth (probably going back to the time when wealth was appraised solely in herds, that is, in skins)—synonym: erezzi.

In human beings one distinguishes several skin colors: the "red," mado, which characterizes the Europeans and the Arabs of the Fezzan (they rarely say: co, "white"); the "brown" or "wheat": alkam which is applied to the dark-complexioned Arabs or to the light Teda.—The slight dusky color: zedo, which

is that of most Teda; finally the somber "black": yasko which characterizes the Black of the south. Figurative expressions: aši tonos: "he dies in his skin," or: aši nosede: "the skin dies" means: "he is ashamed"; "he does not dare,"—aši cesu yeda: literally, "he has sweet skin," that is to say, "he has luck," or even: "he brings luck"—ašide: both wealthy and bringing luck.

aši (pl. ašaa): provisions for the road (the meaning of "provisions" exists only as applied to food for the road).

asiri: secret—asiri tumuri: "I have covered the secret," namely, "I kept the secret."

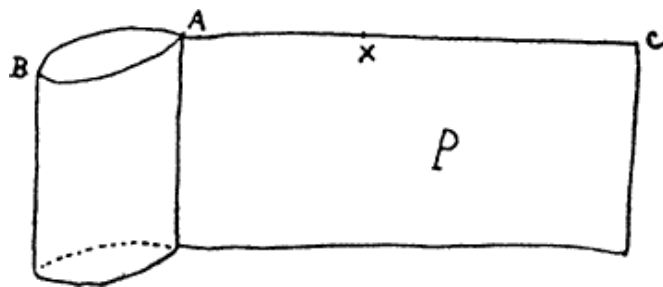
askano: net put on the teats of the she-camel to prevent the young camels from suckling.

aski: (pl. aska): horse—diminutive: askii: colt.

asrano: marrow.

atta: older sister.

attice: large piece of blue cotton fabric of 12 cubits, in which the Teda women drape themselves. It is a rectangle of about three meters fifty (ten to twelve cubits) by one meter fifty, obtained by sewing, edge to edge, two pieces of fabric three meters fifty long by eighty centimeters wide. The end of the rectangle is /sketch appears here/ folded at three-fourths of its length (A) and fastened at this point; the head is drawn through this opening, the point A is on the left shoulder, the return fold B being drawn under the right armpit; then the right hand takes hold of the end C of the section P, draws it under the left arm to bring it forward and to the right side, while  2167 cont.



the left hand holds the edge in the middle (point X of the sketch), twists it up to slip it into the hollow of the neck, like a safety catch. The right hand then draws the section P over the head like a hood and lets the end of the section fall down on the left shoulder. This is the common way of wearing the attice. For work, the section P drawn under the left arm, as mentioned above, instead of being brought up to the right shoulder, is wound around the waist like a skirt, thus leaving the two arms bare: the end of the section, slipped into the fold of the waist, keeps everything in place. For traveling, a leather belt with long, narrow, pendant cords (wurdu) secures the length P to the waist from where it is drawn upward to envelope the right shoulder and the head; it is secured on the head by a leather band which, encircling the forehead, is tied in a knot at the back of the head, with the ends of the band left to hang freely.

For dancing: women whose husbands are away wear the attice wrapped around the waist as for traveling, but much more supple: the wrapping, very loose, forms a drapery falling to the ground; the women whose husbands are present cover their heads in the usual way.

The woman on a visit fastens her attice as for a journey, with a leather belt, but does not draw up the section [P] over the shoulder and the head: she secures the end of the section in the belt and wears on her head, like a shawl, a piece of fabric called arkele. (see photo plates XIII–XIV).^A

awi: desert of sand or gravel without any vegetations. In Kanuri: ténéré. They use this word as for a desert of any size; a simple basin or an immense area.

awoso: to see: abeso.

awozer, awosci, awoser: to be afraid, have fear—awoskosor: to frighten (l).

awöni: again, not again if it accompanies a negative verb—afterward.

ay (pl. ada): adjective and demonstrative pronoun. Ayne: this one; ay koge: like that.

aya: here.

aya or aye: mother—title of respect readily given to aged women.

2268 cont.

aya: need: ndi ayner? ndi aya noō? ndi ayahena? "what does it matter, to me, to you, to him"—By extension aya is applied to the person or thing that one needs or which one pursues (ayaner gartu: "I need you," that is to say: "wait for me").

ayab: extraordinary (in a more pejorative sense) labar ayab: astonishing news; ayabde: bad action or being.

ayangano: woody plant, the decoction of which, sometimes mixed with a little date meal, is used as a remedy for rheumatism. It is dangerous to drink too much of it.

ayamer, ayapci, ayamper: to be astonished.

ayener, ayence, ayenter: to be dishonest.

ayi (pl. aye): a man pilgrim from Mecca.

aynar, aye, ayndar: to accompany one's speech with a gesture.

azami: woman's belt.

azza: woman pilgrim from Mecca.

azzabat: Arabic word with which the Teda of Borku designate prostitutes.

azenno: the bridegroom or the bride during the wedding ceremony.

azeno: ascending road. Old customs prescribed by the Snoussia missionaries but remaining more or less in force in Tibesti demand that when one reaches the summit of one of these slopes and sights new country, one should crush a date or make a libation of milk or butter at the foot of a heap of sacred stones called zeno.

69

azuner, azunce, azunter: to get married. The proposal is made by the young man's father or an aged relative to the person on whom the young girl is dependent, that is to say, ordinarily her father or, if she has no father, one of her uncles or her mother. But the reply can be given only after consultation with all the relatives. If it is negative, the father of the young girl usually pleads a previous request, but it is rare that it does not follow a disagreement between the two families. If it is affirmative, the father of the young man (in a normal case) immediately presents a gift to the father of the young girl, by which one says that the "pearl," namely, the young girl, is bound (eritunte). He also generally gives a gift to the mother. The young man or his father must thus continue to give gifts to all the close relatives of the young girl throughout the duration of the betrothal, which is generally two years. Abduction is possible if one waits too long. If a young girl is very rich, one goes about it differently: before any formal request, each of her suitors gives her father gifts considered as advances (omaso). Ultimately, the father gives

his daughter to the suitor who has given him the most splendid gifts, and reimburses the others. The wedding almost always takes place in a palm grove at the time of the date harvest. ■2369 cont.

The fiancé who, the day before, has generally brought the gifts for his parents-in-law and his fiancée, arrives in the afternoon on a camel, escorted by men of the village, with a small boy not yet circumcised in the saddle behind him, or, if not, a man both of whose parents are living and in harmony. The women of the village go in front of him with you-you, singing and dancing to susumma. He is installed on a mat in the shade of a house where he remains until evening in his handsome costume, without moving and carefully veiled, in the midst of his friends. His fiancée is in the house of her mother with her young companions, very occupied with her toilet, while the women put the final touches on their cooking. The bride's mother is in charge of the reception. But neighbors and relatives are bent on helping her, just as the mother of her fiancé, barring physical impossibility, must bring her partner as many dishes of millet, of barley or wheat as she herself has prepared. Meanwhile, the men come together to conclude the contract officially. They sit in a circle with the fathers of the young people and the representatives (ori) assisting them sitting in the center. The discussion concerns the amount of the "beno" or "sadak" which the young man must give the young girl so that she will become his wife, and the "luli" (literally: hole) which he must give her father to be able to take her to his house after the wedding. Actually, they are already in agreement, but the father of the fiancée makes the most of the qualities of his daughter and of the sacrifice he is making by being separated from her; and the father of the bridegroom, for his part, lays great stress on the value of the gifts he is giving. This discussion has the further advantage of specifying exactly the palm trees or the male or female camels in question and their condition. When all these uncertain points have been clarified and one is in agreement, the representative of the bridegroom's family makes the official request of the bride's family. The dialogue is generally as follows:

doboten ("give me the daughter");

dobonener ("I give you," literally: "I have given you the daughter.")

70

dobonoma cer hena wona? ("What is your daughter's name?");

dobonra cer hena... ("my daughter's name is...")

aba hena wona? (What is her father's");

aba hena... (her father's is...");

ayi hena wona? ("What is her mother's?");

ayi hena... ("her mother's is...").

Each of the questions and answers is repeated three times. At the ninth exchange of answers, the representative of the bridegroom brings the dialogue to an end by crying brusquely and a single time: mar "I take" (literally: "I have taken"), ■2470 cont.or, if he is a good speaker: woyibo hena fo eri yobar: "I take her whole person." Each of these words: woyibo, which means the body and everything that covers it, fo=eri, which means "I mingle," yobar, which means to take several things at once, express the idea of a totality. Then the representative of the bride, for his part, takes the initiative and says: mi ten: "give me the son," and the reverse dialogue takes place, the bridegroom and his family being substituted for the bride and her relatives. At the ninth reply, the representative of the bride cries: mar "I have taken."

It may happen that one of the representatives becomes confused, but the ceremony is nonetheless very solemn. In the end, the bridegroom's representative, for his part, gives a gift (madagal) to the representative of the

bride. If there is a man among the assistants who knows the Koran, one then calls upon him to recite the fatiha which is concluded by all folding their hands in the sacred manner and repeating: "al fatiha" with impressive gravity. Five francs are given to the marabout; if there is no marabout, they are content with the end formula. The marriage is then concluded; it is not an indissoluble bond but, for the moment, the wish of all is that nothing will break it, and to give the signal of departure, one chooses an old man married for a long time who has never been separated from his wife. Agreement is quickly reached and the old man rises very slowly then sits down again and rises, three times. At this happy forecast, or this sort of benediction, they all disperse. The young people go to watch the female dancers who have come from the neighboring villages decked out in their finery, who sing, while dancing, the praises of the families that have become united (see: abi).

During this time, the women erect a large hut of mats which, divided into two compartments, sometimes separated by a middle section, serves as the nuptial house. In the center, a man faithful to his wife symbolically drives in a sine yedi: "stick on which to hang a goatskin," at the foot of which they bury a libation of millet and of wheat of barley porridge, milk, butter and water. The surplus butter is used by the women present to rub on their hands and arms. When the night is well along, a camel is brought to the bridegroom who mounts it. The women accompany him, interrupting his progress with "susumma" dancing, one of them burns perfume in front of the camel, the men fire shots. They finally arrive at the wedding hut which they encircle three times and in front of which the bridegroom sits down. All the young boys scatter in search of the bride whom her friends have hidden under a tree in the vicinity of her mother's hut. When they have found her, they run to forestall her, and a group of young men hasten with their camel to take the young girl by force, and, in spite of her resistance and that of her girl friends, throw her by force athwart the camel to take her at a gallop to the nuptial hut which they encircle three times before taking her into the compartment reserved for her. The young girl weeps and struggles, supported by her maternal aunt (dodo) whom the bridegroom's men must appease with a small gift resembling that which the bridegroom has already taken to the other uncles and aunts; if there is not maternal aunt, another relative of the bride replaces her in her role of opposition to the very end. The rest of the night is spent in dancing, the two betrothed being always separated.

The next morning, the father of the young girl slaughters, or has slaughtered by one of his relatives, a goat, the feet of which a relative of the young man holds. It is cooked, then a thigh and half of the heart is taken to the bridegroom, the other thigh and the other half of the heart to the bride. They must take a bite of it, after which the man and woman who have brought these pieces finish eating them. The rest of the meat is eaten by the men at the festival. In the afternoon, a woman undoes the three virginal plaits of the young girl and braids the two plaits of the married woman. Between the two plaits she trickles a little milk, being careful that it runs down the middle of her forehead and onto her nose. Then a piece of fragrant wood is placed in the fire. When there is nothing left but a charred piece, it is placed on a flat millstone. The bride, passing her hand under the mat that separates her compartment from that of the bridegroom, takes the small stone serving as pestle; the bridegroom lays his hand over hers, the woman who has dressed the bride, in turn, takes the hand of the bridegroom, a man who assists the latter takes the hand of the woman, and the four hands together symbolically try to crush the fragrant piece of charred wood. It is on the evening of this day that the consummation of the marriage finally takes place. The rule requires that the bride struggle, though a friend is probably never obliged to come to hold her feet, as this is done among the Kanuri. At the moment of defloration she utters a faint cry to which her mother, who is waiting for it, responds with a you-you, followed by the you-you of the women of the village. As a reward for her virginity, the husband gives his young wife a very fine gift (anmarke or lomarke): a silver bracelet or its equivalent. In the morning, the mat stained

with blood is  2671 cont. displayed on the roof of the nuptial hut, and the friends of the couple join the two, each in his compartment. They exchange jokes, the women reproach the man for his violence, the men reproach the woman for having resisted. If the wife has not yet reached puberty, this wedding night is postponed two or three years, the husband continuing to give gifts in the interval. Nothing is changed in the rest of the ceremony. The spouses remain secluded in their hut a total of seven days. The day they leave it, a pestle and mortar of wood are placed in front of the door, filled with millet, which is set on a sheepskin. The newly-married couple strike three blows of the pestle. Then the husband and wife try to take the mortar away from each other. Sometimes, to intensify the struggle, all the men of the village pull on one side, while the women pull on the other. According to which side wins, one forecasts whether the one who will rule in the household will be the man or the woman and 72 it is a subject of much joking, especially if the woman prevails. With the grain that is then gathered, the young wife, assisted by her friends, cooks the first conjugal dish. The father of the wife generally gives his son-in-law a gift called: cenofor, equal or superior to those that he had received from him. The marriage ceremonies have ended. But during the weeks that follow, the two spouses still receive many gifts called kobori which, for the young woman, consist chiefly of household objects given her by the other women of the two families. The couple build their hut near that of the woman's mother, and the husband generally waits one or two years, or even until the birth of his first child, to pay the luli, which permits him, if he wishes, to install his household near his own mother.

When the woman has already been married, one restricts oneself, in principle, to the fatiha ceremony; however, it may happen that a nuptial hut is built to which one solemnly escorts the two spouses. The gifts may be limited to the sadaka given to the woman, but to give nothing to the father-in-law will, on the part of the husband, will be proof of very little love, and gradually one is becoming more generous. Whether or not the man has already been married changes nothing in the ceremony if his spouse is a virgin. However, the relatives do not give the husband gifts a second time.

A, /For Plate XXVII, see Category 535, p. 303 ff.—Analyst/

A, /For Plates XIII–XIV, see Category 291, pp. 240–250—Analyst/

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